

# SELLI Gym

20 sessions · 8 questions each · 10 minutes. Train like you will be tested.

## How the Gym works

You will **hear** a short dialogue between a man (M) and a woman (W), then a question (N). You only **see** the four options. Choose the best answer. This is exactly the SELLI/ITP format: the recording is not printed anywhere, and it does not wait for you. Each session has an **official audio file** with the answer time built in: your teacher presses play once, and the recording runs the whole session — item numbers, dialogues, questions and silences — just like exam day.

| Sessions              | Focus                                                                         | Listens allowed | Seconds to answer |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------|
| <b>CORE BLOCK</b>     |                                                                               |                 |                   |
| 1–3                   | context, details, sounds                                                      | twice           | 15                |
| 4–7                   | negatives, deduction, functions                                               | once            | 15                |
| 8–10                  | conditionals, idioms, mixed                                                   | once            | 10                |
| <b>ADVANCED BLOCK</b> |                                                                               |                 |                   |
| 11–17                 | numbers, referents, causatives, responses, harder verbs & idioms, comparisons | <b>once</b>     | <b>10</b>         |
| 18–19                 | long conversation · mini-lectures                                             | once            | 12                |
| 20                    | final boss: everything, C1 flavor                                             | <b>once</b>     | <b>10</b>         |

## Golden rules of the Gym

1. Read the four options **before** the audio starts. Predict the question.
2. The wrong options often **repeat words you heard**. The right one usually **rephrases** the idea.
3. Sound-alike words (*quiz/quit*, *ceiling/sealing*) are traps, not clues.
4. A negative or an idiom can flip the whole meaning. That is what they test.
5. Never leave a blank: an unanswered item is a guaranteed zero.

## My progress

| Session    | 1  | 2  | 3  | 4  | 5  | 6  | 7  | 8  | 9  | 10 |
|------------|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| Score (/8) |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| Date       |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| Session    | 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 | 17 | 18 | 19 | 20 |
| Score (/8) |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| Date       |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |

6+ = SELLI pace. Three sessions in a row at 6+ = you are ready for the next block. Survive Session 20 at 6+ and the real exam will feel familiar. 💪

💡 **Strategy of the day.** Nobody will say "we are in a pharmacy". Catch the job words and place words (*prescription, aisle, warranty, beaker*) and let them place the scene for you.

- |    |                                                             |                                                                |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) At a basketball game<br>(C) On an airplane              | (B) In a theater<br>(D) In a parking garage                    |
| 2. | (A) A pharmacist<br>(C) A doctor                            | (B) A chemistry teacher<br>(D) A flight attendant              |
| 3. | (A) In an appliance store<br>(C) At a bank                  | (B) In a repair shop<br>(D) In a library                       |
| 4. | (A) Fixing a computer<br>(C) Applying for a job             | (B) Finishing a class assignment<br>(D) Closing the laboratory |
| 5. | (A) At a train station<br>(C) At a bus stop                 | (B) At a hotel reception<br>(D) At an airline counter          |
| 6. | (A) In a doctor's office<br>(C) In a pharmacy               | (B) In a supermarket<br>(D) In a candy store                   |
| 7. | (A) A clothing store employee<br>(C) A fashion photographer | (B) A window cleaner<br>(D) A delivery driver                  |
| 8. | (A) In a kitchen<br>(C) In a bakery                         | (B) At a gas station<br>(D) In a chemistry lab                 |

💡 **Strategy of the day.** The correct option almost never repeats the words you heard — it **rephrases** them. If an option copies the audio word for word, suspect it.

- |    |                                                                               |                                                                                    |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) She did very well<br>(C) She asked the wrong questions                    | (B) She did not take the exam<br>(D) She expected a better grade                   |
| 2. | (A) It was approved quickly<br>(C) It happened last month                     | (B) The committee rejected it<br>(D) It was postponed                              |
| 3. | (A) The museum never opens on Mondays<br>(C) It opens only in summer          | (B) It is closed on Mondays most of the year<br>(D) It is open every day in winter |
| 4. | (A) The internship should pay in gold<br>(C) The experience is very valuable  | (B) Marta should ask for a salary<br>(D) The internship is a waste of time         |
| 5. | (A) She does not want to take it again<br>(C) She has never taken the seminar | (B) She wants to repeat the seminar<br>(D) One seminar is never enough             |
| 6. | (A) They will camp in the rain<br>(C) They will have to cancel the trip       | (B) The trip starts on the weekend<br>(D) They should leave right now              |
| 7. | (A) The list was damaged<br>(C) She finished it with difficulty               | (B) She has read very little of it<br>(D) She dented her car                       |
| 8. | (A) It includes two chargers<br>(C) The old one was twice as fast             | (B) It is cheaper than the old one<br>(D) It is much more expensive                |

 **Strategy of the day.** *Quiz/quit, ceiling/sealing, fog/frog.* If an option depends on a word that merely **sounds like** what you heard, it is bait.

- |    |                                                                                   |                                                                                     |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) He quit teaching the course<br>(C) The quiz includes chapters one to four     | (B) The quiz has four questions<br>(D) Students should buy four book covers         |
| 2. | (A) The floor is being replaced<br>(C) The staff went sailing                     | (B) Maintenance work is being done<br>(D) The windows lost their sealing            |
| 3. | (A) She caught the train in two minutes<br>(C) She waited for two more trains     | (B) The train was two minutes late<br>(D) The train left shortly before she arrived |
| 4. | (A) Next to the printer<br>(C) Under the desk                                     | (B) Inside the printer<br>(D) Beside the door                                       |
| 5. | (A) A frog was on the runway<br>(C) The flowers blocked the gate                  | (B) Because of bad weather<br>(D) It arrived an hour early                          |
| 6. | (A) Tuesday at noon<br>(C) Friday noon                                            | (B) Wednesday morning<br>(D) Thursday at midday                                     |
| 7. | (A) Some tickets remain for the afternoon show<br>(C) Only evening tickets remain | (B) Everything is completely sold out<br>(D) The show was canceled                  |
| 8. | (A) He wanted the exercise<br>(C) His car broke down                              | (B) He started walking to his car<br>(D) He would rather not walk                   |

💡 **Strategy of the day.** One *not*, *never* or *nowhere* reverses the sentence. Locate the negative first; then decide what is actually true.

- |    |                                                                                  |                                                                                           |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) They matched perfectly<br>(C) The readings were expected                     | (B) They were close to the prediction<br>(D) They were very different from the prediction |
| 2. | (A) She stopped going when the menu changed<br>(C) She eats there only sometimes | (B) She has never eaten there<br>(D) She changed her own diet                             |
| 3. | (A) He refuses to present<br>(C) He will present once the schedule is set        | (B) He already presented<br>(D) The schedule was confirmed today                          |
| 4. | (A) He failed like everyone else<br>(C) He did not participate                   | (B) He was the only one who passed<br>(D) He ran the trial twice                          |
| 5. | (A) The room filled up very quickly<br>(C) The meeting was slower than usual     | (B) The room stayed empty<br>(D) No meeting was scheduled                                 |
| 6. | (A) The ending was hopeful<br>(C) It ended as she expected                       | (B) She has not finished the novel<br>(D) She was disappointed by the ending              |
| 7. | (A) Registration is still open<br>(C) The workshop was canceled                  | (B) They can register only if a place opens up<br>(D) Nobody registered for the workshop  |
| 8. | (A) The interns broke the rules<br>(C) Sofia explained all the rules             | (B) Nobody explained the rules<br>(D) Sofia is a new intern                               |

💡 **Strategy of the day.** *Hardly, barely, scarcely, seldom, few* mean “almost zero”. And *not uncommon* means **common**. Small words, huge exam favorites.

- |    |                                                                             |                                                                                |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) He always gives extensions<br>(C) He gives them to hard workers         | (B) He almost never gives extensions<br>(D) He never taught before             |
| 2. | (A) The announcement was very clear<br>(C) The speakers were too loud       | (B) He heard it twice<br>(D) He could almost not hear it                       |
| 3. | (A) Repeating experiments is normal there<br>(C) The lab forbids repetition | (B) It is very unusual<br>(D) Three times is too many                          |
| 4. | (A) He is scared of the job<br>(C) He has had very little time so far       | (B) He learned the basics quickly<br>(D) He wastes his time                    |
| 5. | (A) The machines rarely fail<br>(C) They are often repaired                 | (B) They break down every week<br>(D) She has never used them                  |
| 6. | (A) He rested before the project<br>(C) He finished the project early       | (B) The project began right after the exam<br>(D) He slept through the project |
| 7. | (A) They missed the deadline<br>(C) The prototype stayed unfinished         | (B) They finished during the day<br>(D) They had to work through the night     |
| 8. | (A) Many students are afraid<br>(C) Almost nobody signed up                 | (B) The trip is full<br>(D) A few more are expected                            |

💡 **Strategy of the day.** *Must have* = almost sure it happened; *can't have* = almost sure it did NOT; *might/may have* = possible.  
Your Unit 7 grammar, exam version.

- |    |                                                                                         |                                                                                    |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) Luis is required to leave<br>(C) Luis has probably gone home                        | (B) Luis lost his coat<br>(D) Luis never came to work                              |
| 2. | (A) Someone almost certainly failed to seal them<br>(C) The containers cannot be sealed | (B) Nobody is allowed to seal them<br>(D) She sealed them herself                  |
| 3. | (A) Rita should study more<br>(C) Rita wrote the review                                 | (B) Rita probably studied a lot<br>(D) Rita must study next week                   |
| 4. | (A) Jorge arrived late to the conference<br>(C) Jorge organized it from Peru            | (B) Jorge could not find the conference<br>(D) The person was definitely not Jorge |
| 5. | (A) The technician always forgets<br>(C) The tank is definitely broken                  | (B) Possibly the valve was left open<br>(D) Someone mopped the floor               |
| 6. | (A) Karen always loses remotes<br>(C) The remote is in this classroom                   | (B) Karen must return it today<br>(D) Perhaps Karen has the remote                 |
| 7. | (A) The students were amazed<br>(C) The man should watch the students                   | (B) The students missed the demonstration<br>(D) The robot failed again            |
| 8. | (A) Somebody forgot to pay the light bill<br>(C) Someone was probably working overnight | (B) The lab is open to everyone at night<br>(D) The experiment must start tonight  |

💡 **Strategy of the day.** Suggestions, offers, requests: *Why don't you...? Let me... Would you mind...?* — and remember: "Not at all" after "Would you mind" means **yes, I agree**.

- |    |                                                                                   |                                                                         |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) Dividing the paragraph in two<br>(C) Asking why it is confusing               | (B) Deleting the paragraph<br>(D) Writing a longer sentence             |
| 2. | (A) The woman should lift more<br>(C) He offers to help with the heaviest samples | (B) He cannot carry anything<br>(D) The storeroom is too far            |
| 3. | (A) Refuse to change the volume<br>(C) Turn the music up                          | (B) Lower the volume<br>(D) Stop the recording                          |
| 4. | (A) The circuit sounds strange<br>(C) Lunch is more important                     | (B) He prefers to test after lunch<br>(D) He agrees to test it first    |
| 5. | (A) He should book them as soon as possible<br>(C) She prefers morning flights    | (B) Earlier flights are cheaper<br>(D) Booking can wait until next week |
| 6. | (A) He will cover the shift<br>(C) He wishes to travel with her                   | (B) He cannot cover the shift<br>(D) He works out of town on Fridays    |
| 7. | (A) Backing away from the computer<br>(C) Buying new files                        | (B) Canceling the update<br>(D) Saving copies of the files              |
| 8. | (A) Dropping the course immediately<br>(C) Consulting the advisor first           | (B) Becoming an academic advisor<br>(D) Taking an extra course          |

💡 **Strategy of the day.** Unreal conditionals state facts in disguise: *If I had known...* = I did NOT know. *I wish it worked* = it does NOT work. Undo the hypothesis to find the fact. One listen, 10 seconds.

- |    |                                                                                    |                                                                                           |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) He started the report early<br>(C) The deadline did not move                   | (B) He did not know the deadline had changed<br>(D) He refused to start sooner            |
| 2. | (A) The printer was repaired<br>(C) The printer works well                         | (B) She needs a faster computer<br>(D) The printer is slow                                |
| 3. | (A) They missed the opening talk<br>(C) The bus almost broke down                  | (B) They arrived on time<br>(D) They gave the opening talk                                |
| 4. | (A) The test happens rain or shine<br>(C) Continued rain will cancel the test      | (B) The rain stopped at noon<br>(D) The test was moved indoors                            |
| 5. | (A) He saved every version<br>(C) He did not save the earlier version              | (B) The earlier version was worse<br>(D) He will save it tomorrow                         |
| 6. | (A) The unclear results delayed the publication<br>(C) The results were very clear | (B) The paper appeared in spring<br>(D) They refused to publish                           |
| 7. | (A) She already registered<br>(C) She would rather stay home                       | (B) The scholarship was approved today<br>(D) She would sign up immediately if she got it |
| 8. | (A) She bikes to campus daily<br>(C) The campus has no parking                     | (B) The traffic keeps her from biking<br>(D) She would rather drive than bike             |

 **Strategy of the day.** Your Unit 8–10 vocabulary, exam version. The literal reading (*tell me about it* = *explícame*) is ALWAYS one of the wrong options. One listen, 10 seconds.

- |    |                                                                                 |                                                                                      |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) He wrote the chapter downstairs<br>(C) He shortened the chapter             | (B) He gave up on the last chapter<br>(D) He finally started working on it seriously |
| 2. | (A) She must finish pending reports<br>(C) She watches movies in the lab        | (B) She will catch the late show<br>(D) She finished her reports early               |
| 3. | (A) It fell off the table<br>(C) It was approved late                           | (B) It failed after seeming secure<br>(D) He submitted it a minute late              |
| 4. | (A) She wants him to explain the schedule<br>(C) She completely agrees with him | (B) She just heard about the schedule<br>(D) She wrote the schedule herself          |
| 5. | (A) They rejected it completely<br>(C) They approved it instantly               | (B) They asked for a flatter roof<br>(D) They turned the drawing over                |
| 6. | (A) How she builds upstairs<br>(C) Why she plays loud music                     | (B) Where she puts her earplugs<br>(D) How she tolerates the noise                   |
| 7. | (A) The patch worked perfectly<br>(C) They stopped building the prototype       | (B) They finally had to rebuild everything<br>(D) The sensor fixed itself            |
| 8. | (A) Bring the budget to dinner<br>(C) Avoid mentioning the budget cuts          | (B) Discuss the cuts openly<br>(D) Cancel the dinner                                 |

💡 **Strategy of the day.** Everything mixed, hardest versions: inversions, double meanings, formal conditionals. One listen, 10 seconds. This is the real thing.

- |    |                                                                                   |                                                                           |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) He flew earlier than planned<br>(C) He could not fly because of cancellations | (B) He decided not to travel<br>(D) He canceled his own ticket            |
| 2. | (A) The lab is unusually full today<br>(C) The lab is almost empty                | (B) He rarely visits the lab<br>(D) He cannot see the lab                 |
| 3. | (A) Elena enjoys transfers<br>(C) Elena's eyesight improved                       | (B) Elena did not hear the news<br>(D) Elena is having a hard time        |
| 4. | (A) It was somewhat boring<br>(C) She missed the keynote                          | (B) It was very interesting<br>(D) It was about nothing                   |
| 5. | (A) Guests should avoid the front desk<br>(C) The desk opens only at night        | (B) The desk closes early if needed<br>(D) Help is available at any hour  |
| 6. | (A) He cannot contact the supplier<br>(C) He refuses to wonder about it           | (B) He keeps doubting the decision<br>(D) He helped choose the supplier   |
| 7. | (A) She always misses at least one error<br>(C) Her writing has no errors         | (B) She never proofreads her work<br>(D) She slips when typing            |
| 8. | (A) The project ended months ago<br>(C) The grant has kept the project alive      | (B) Dr. Sandoval folded the documents<br>(D) The project needs no funding |

 **Strategy of the day.** In number and time items, the figure you hear is almost never the answer. Do one quick operation in your head — add, subtract, double, halve — before looking at the options. Any choice that simply repeats a number from the audio is probably a trap.

- |    |                                                                       |                                                                                   |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) At half past three<br>(C) At three fifty                          | (B) At ten past three<br>(D) At twenty past three                                 |
| 2. | (A) Sixty dollars<br>(C) Ninety dollars                               | (B) Fifteen dollars<br>(D) Thirty dollars                                         |
| 3. | (A) Twenty-four<br>(C) Six                                            | (B) A dozen<br>(D) Two                                                            |
| 4. | (A) She runs every single morning<br>(C) She skips a day between runs | (B) She has stopped running completely<br>(D) She injured her knees while running |
| 5. | (A) Exactly one hour<br>(C) About two hours                           | (B) Thirty minutes<br>(D) About ninety minutes                                    |
| 6. | (A) At a quarter to five<br>(C) At five past five                     | (B) At a quarter past five<br>(D) At twenty to five                               |
| 7. | (A) Twelve dollars<br>(C) Four dollars                                | (B) Forty-eight dollars<br>(D) Twenty-four dollars                                |
| 8. | (A) Three<br>(C) Twelve                                               | (B) Six<br>(D) Nine                                                               |

**💡 Strategy of the day.** When several people are mentioned, match each action to its doer before answering. Passives flip the order: the subject of 'was given' receives, and the noun after 'by' acts. With 'got it done', someone else did the job. The first name you hear is bait as often as it is the answer.

- |    |                                                         |                                                      |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) The dean<br>(C) Professor Rivas                     | (B) The committee members<br>(D) The woman           |
| 2. | (A) The students' grader<br>(C) The course instructor   | (B) The lab students<br>(D) The man                  |
| 3. | (A) Daniela herself<br>(C) The man                      | (B) The woman<br>(D) A professional hairdresser      |
| 4. | (A) Professor Chen's<br>(C) The woman's                 | (B) Luis's<br>(D) The man's                          |
| 5. | (A) A member of the grounds crew<br>(C) A librarian     | (B) A campus security officer<br>(D) The man         |
| 6. | (A) Tomas<br>(C) Beatriz                                | (B) The department head<br>(D) The man               |
| 7. | (A) The retiring coach<br>(C) The athletic director     | (B) One of his players<br>(D) The woman              |
| 8. | (A) Professor Ibarra<br>(C) A team of field technicians | (B) The man<br>(D) The members of his research group |

**💡 Strategy of the day.** Causatives shift the doer: 'have/get something done' means someone else performs the job, 'make' forces, 'let' permits, 'help' assists. When you hear have, get, make, or let, decide instantly who really acts; the wrong options usually hand the action back to the speaker.

- |                                                                                                     |                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. (A) She looked at the transmission herself<br>(C) A mechanic inspected the vehicle               | (B) She plans to take the car in soon<br>(D) She bought a smoother car last week                        |
| 2. (A) She fixed the laptop by herself<br>(C) She bought a new laptop near campus                   | (B) A technician repaired her computer<br>(D) She turned in her thesis a day late                       |
| 3. (A) He required students to start their work over<br>(C) He canceled the seminar projects        | (B) He rewrote the proposals for the class<br>(D) He let students hand in rough drafts                  |
| 4. (A) Borrow a spare from the lab manager<br>(C) Ask to take the exam ten minutes late             | (B) Run home to get his own calculator<br>(D) Use the calculator the woman offers                       |
| 5. (A) The department staff painted it themselves<br>(C) The screens will be put in after the break | (B) A crew gave the walls a fresh coat<br>(D) The man repainted it over the semester                    |
| 6. (A) Her advisor refused to read the abstract<br>(C) She read her advisor's paper two times       | (B) She submitted the abstract without approval<br>(D) Her advisor had to approve it before it went out |
| 7. (A) Someone on his team will supply the data<br>(C) He will help the woman write the report      | (B) He will send the results himself at lunch<br>(D) The woman should assist him after lunch            |
| 8. (A) She checked the slides for mistakes<br>(C) A specialist examined her vision                  | (B) She skipped the lecture to finish reading<br>(D) She gave a lecture off campus                      |

**💡 Strategy of the day.** Short responses carry meaning through function, not words. 'So do I' and 'Neither can I' copy the polarity of the previous line; 'You can say that again' and 'That makes two of us' signal strong agreement. Identify the function of the reply before you look at the options.

- |    |                                                                                               |                                                                                              |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) He finds the annex too noisy for studying<br>(C) He wants the woman to concentrate harder | (B) He prefers the same quiet spot<br>(D) He can concentrate almost anywhere on campus       |
| 2. | (A) She is equally confused by the material<br>(C) She thinks the homework is already due     | (B) She can make sense of the notes<br>(D) She tutors students in thermodynamics             |
| 3. | (A) He wants the woman to repeat her comment<br>(C) He answered every question with ease      | (B) He thinks she should take the exam again<br>(D) He fully agrees the test was tough       |
| 4. | (A) She could not agree to register online<br>(C) She thinks the system is a big improvement  | (B) She stood in line for hours this semester<br>(D) She needs five more minutes to register |
| 5. | (A) He expects the place to be closed<br>(C) He wants the evening hours extended              | (B) He has no doubt it will stay open<br>(D) He forgot when finals week begins               |
| 6. | (A) She knows the winners were posted today<br>(C) She is not serving on the committee        | (B) She refuses to check the website again<br>(D) As far as she can tell, the list is not up |
| 7. | (A) He left his things at the conference<br>(C) He will meet the dancers later that night     | (B) He is turning down the invitation<br>(D) He wants help getting through his grading       |
| 8. | (A) She will present jointly with the man<br>(C) She feels just as anxious as the man         | (B) She thinks the man rehearsed for two weeks<br>(D) She has two talks scheduled tomorrow   |

 **Strategy of the day.** Phrasal verbs rarely mean what their parts suggest. Treat verb plus particle as one chunk and ask what it means in context. The correct answer paraphrases that meaning; options that repeat the literal verb or echo exact words from the audio are usually traps.

- |    |                                                                                                 |                                                                                                   |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) She had a minor collision at the store<br>(C) She ran all the way to the bookstore          | (B) She unexpectedly met a former instructor<br>(D) She had arranged to meet the professor        |
| 2. | (A) He walked across the room for his notes<br>(C) He will take notes at the next seminar       | (B) He threw his old notes away while cleaning<br>(D) He found the notes without looking for them |
| 3. | (A) Ask the staff to examine the billing error<br>(C) Pay the tuition charge a second time      | (B) Look inside the registrar's office herself<br>(D) Report her roommate to the registrar        |
| 4. | (A) Fill out paperwork for Professor Vega<br>(C) Lead the lab while the professor is away       | (B) Watch Professor Vega teach the lab<br>(D) Trust the students with the equipment               |
| 5. | (A) She ran all the way to her morning class<br>(C) There was no coffee left when she went      | (B) The cafeteria closes before nine o'clock<br>(D) The vending machine was out of order          |
| 6. | (A) He went downstairs the night before<br>(C) His co-author caught the flu from him            | (B) He suddenly became ill before the event<br>(D) His slides were not finished on time           |
| 7. | (A) They will cut up some travel documents<br>(C) They will come back from trips earlier        | (B) The equipment fund is also shrinking<br>(D) The department will spend less on travel          |
| 8. | (A) Who will run the class during her absence<br>(C) Whether the seminar will move to Monterrey | (B) Who will carry her books over to campus<br>(D) When Dr. Fuentes will finish her sabbatical    |

 **Strategy of the day.** An idiom's meaning is not the sum of its words. Expect one option that reads the idiom literally and one that recycles words you heard. Choose the option that restates the speaker's intention in plain language, even when it shares no vocabulary with the audio.

- |                                                                                               |                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. (A) He lit an oil lamp to keep working<br>(C) He stayed up very late working               | (B) He missed the deadline this morning<br>(D) He slept through his alarm today        |
| 2. (A) She has not made up her mind yet<br>(C) She has decided not to go to Canada            | (B) She is sitting on a fence outside<br>(D) She already accepted the program offer    |
| 3. (A) His feet got cold before the defense<br>(C) He asked for a shorter thesis proposal     | (B) He defended his proposal earlier today<br>(D) He lost his nerve at the last minute |
| 4. (A) Go to the game with her friends<br>(C) Knock a pile of books off her desk              | (B) Study for her upcoming final exams<br>(D) Buy the textbooks she needs for finals   |
| 5. (A) Victory is possible but not very likely<br>(C) Strange teams usually win tournaments   | (B) Their robot can shoot from far away<br>(D) The team should skip the national event |
| 6. (A) The corners of the wing were rounded off<br>(C) The work may have been done carelessly | (B) The project ran two months over budget<br>(D) The lab wing opening will be delayed |
| 7. (A) He never heard the campus bell ring<br>(C) He thinks the woman is mistaken             | (B) He remembers the seminar clearly<br>(D) The name is unfamiliar to him              |
| 8. (A) Summer break has been officially canceled<br>(C) The man grabbed her leg by accident   | (B) She knows the man is only joking<br>(D) She finds the statistics class amusing     |

**💡 Strategy of the day.** First decide which option the speaker actually favors and how strongly. Rather/prefer choose the first item named; 'not nearly as' means far less; 'might as well' is a casual suggestion; 'more trouble than it is worth' means quit. Distractors flip direction or degree — match meaning, not words.

- |                                                                                                          |                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. (A) She would rather take the online section<br>(C) She thinks two-hour lectures are too long         | (B) She prefers attending class in person<br>(D) She plans to stare at a screen all semester      |
| 2. (A) Waiting forty minutes for the shuttle<br>(C) Going there on foot instead of waiting               | (B) Taking a different shuttle route<br>(D) Walking for forty minutes                             |
| 3. (A) It is far more expensive than her old one<br>(C) It is twice as big as her old apartment          | (B) It costs half what the downtown place did<br>(D) She wants to move back downtown              |
| 4. (A) It was nearly as tough as the practice tests<br>(C) The practice tests were easier than the final | (B) The final was harder than he had expected<br>(D) The final was easier than the practice tests |
| 5. (A) She would rather write the report<br>(C) She is equally good at writing and speaking              | (B) She wants to give the presentation first<br>(D) She enjoys speaking in front of a crowd       |
| 6. (A) He will arrive at the conference sooner<br>(C) He enjoyed his last ride in the van                | (B) He plans to walk the whole way there<br>(D) He really does not want to ride in the van        |
| 7. (A) The projector was worth the trouble<br>(C) She fixed it after a lot of trouble                    | (B) Repairing it did not justify the effort<br>(D) Someone else repaired it for the seminar       |
| 8. (A) They should wait until spots open in October<br>(C) They ought to reserve the buses right away    | (B) The trip itself should take place sooner<br>(D) The buses are already full for October        |

**💡 Strategy of the day.** Take quick notes on every number, date, and condition: totals, partial amounts, and deadlines often reappear as separate answer choices. Also track who does what; an action the advisor offers to do herself is a classic trap for what the student will do next.

- |                                                                                                    |                                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. (A) Choosing electives in chemical engineering<br>(C) Changing majors and what it would involve | (B) Applying for a merit scholarship<br>(D) Finding a summer internship at a plant            |
| 2. (A) Forty-two<br>(C) Ten                                                                        | (B) Thirty-four<br>(D) Eight                                                                  |
| 3. (A) By the tenth of October<br>(C) By the end of January                                        | (B) By Monday of next week<br>(D) Within the next three months                                |
| 4. (A) Both programs require hours in a plant<br>(C) It must wait until his final year             | (B) It lasts two hundred forty days<br>(D) Only his intended program includes one             |
| 5. (A) It pays for ten semesters of study<br>(C) He loses it the moment he transfers               | (B) It would end before he graduates<br>(D) It covers the cost of the internship              |
| 6. (A) A late request means a long wait<br>(C) It rarely approves change requests                  | (B) It meets several times each term<br>(D) It will review his form this Monday               |
| 7. (A) He thinks it is not worth the trouble<br>(C) He blames the advisor for the extra cost       | (B) He expects the scholarship to cover it<br>(D) He sees it as an acceptable trade-off       |
| 8. (A) Hand the form to the registrar himself<br>(C) Weigh the decision for a few days             | (B) Begin industrial engineering classes right away<br>(D) Ask the committee for an extension |

💡 **Strategy of the day.** Mini-lectures pack facts quickly. Jot down places, times, amounts, and any negatives such as not by email. For vocabulary questions, the everyday meaning of the word is usually the trap: rely on the sentence around it, not on the word alone.

- |                                                                                                       |                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. (A) To announce a change in laboratory schedules<br>(C) To warn about rising fees on campus        | (B) To report an accident in room two twelve<br>(D) To explain a step students must take before lab work |
| 2. (A) In room two twelve<br>(C) In the campus laboratory                                             | (B) In the main auditorium<br>(D) In the registration office                                             |
| 3. (A) Get at least eight of ten questions right<br>(C) Pay a two hundred peso fee                    | (B) Attend two ninety-minute sessions<br>(D) Email a completed registration form                         |
| 4. (A) They will be dropped from the lab course<br>(C) They must pay to get back into the lab         | (B) They can take the quiz again by email<br>(D) Their access cards will be replaced at no cost          |
| 5. (A) It creates a sound wave opposite to the noise<br>(C) It records the road noise for later study | (B) It blocks sound before it reaches the ear<br>(D) It lines up two microphones on each earcup          |
| 6. (A) A small flying machine<br>(C) A continuous deep hum                                            | (B) A sudden loud bang<br>(D) A part of the headphone microphone                                         |
| 7. (A) It cancels every sound around the listener<br>(C) It makes nearby voices disappear completely  | (B) It copes better with constant sounds than abrupt ones<br>(D) It performs best on high-pitched noises |
| 8. (A) To compare popular brands of headphones<br>(C) To describe how engines produce rumble          | (B) To warn listeners about hearing damage<br>(D) To explain how a device quiets unwanted sound          |

💡 **Strategy of the day.** Every item stacks two traps. Untangle inversions first (Little did we know = we did not know; Had we known = we did not); read understatement as criticism (I've had better = it was bad); treat 'as far as I can tell' as a hedge; and test idioms for double meanings before trusting literal echoes.

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|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | (A) The lab was so cold that the robot arm froze<br>(C) The deans canceled the demo at the last minute     | (B) They knew a little about the battery problem<br>(D) An unexpected power issue stopped the demo    |
| 2. | (A) The system was replaced just in time<br>(C) He needs someone to draft the budget request               | (B) A replacement is long overdue<br>(D) There is no time left to replace the system                  |
| 3. | (A) It is not as good as she would like<br>(C) She cannot tell the coffee from the pastries                | (B) It leaves her wanting a second cup<br>(D) It is the best thing at the new cart                    |
| 4. | (A) The rules were tightened before the audit began<br>(C) The office became stricter because of the audit | (B) The audit found money missing from the office<br>(D) Only the accounting office was audited       |
| 5. | (A) The cafeteria should cater the next banquet<br>(C) She had a better meal right after the banquet       | (B) The banquet food was nothing special<br>(D) She skipped the banquet and ate at the cafeteria      |
| 6. | (A) They knew the registrar would respond late<br>(C) The registrar will send the figures next month       | (B) The numbers were compiled weeks ago<br>(D) They did not expect the registrar to be so slow        |
| 7. | (A) She took all her belongings out of the office<br>(C) She appears to be coping with the problem calmly  | (B) Facilities has been unable to reach her<br>(D) Her office has already been repaired               |
| 8. | (A) The talk was weak in content and design<br>(C) The slides won an award at the symposium                | (B) The speaker mentioned his results only once<br>(D) The keynote was the highlight of the symposium |